

MUSTARD SEED

Faith-Driven Business Incubator & Venture Capital

Empowering Small Businesses Through Embedded Expertise

The Problem

Why small businesses fail, and current solutions fall short

60%

of UK startups fail
within 5 years

73%

of owners lack
a critical skill

15%

decline in bank
lending to SMEs

12 wks

avg accelerator
programme length

Small businesses fail because they lack management, financial, and marketing expertise.
Existing support is too short (12-week cohorts), too shallow (mentorship only), or too expensive (consulting fees).

**The gap in the market. No one offers long-term, embedded operational expertise with aligned incentives.
Until now.**

The Solution

Embedded growth partnership, not advice from the sidelines

Embed

We work inside your business (finance, marketing, ops)

Align

10-15% equity, staged.
We profit only when you succeed.

Separate

Training & financial aid
priced independently.
Pay for what you need.

Pilot

3-month trial with
milestones & mutual
exit rights

Unlike Techstars (13 weeks, 5%, mentorship) or Seedcamp (7%, passive seed investment), Mustard Seed provides months of hands-on operational integration. Your equity pays for embedded management consulting. Training and financial services are separate, affordable fees.

"From the smallest seed grows the largest tree". We invest in potential, not pedigree.

Market Opportunity

A £12.8B market with a wide-open niche

TAM

£12.8B

UK small business
support services

SAM

£1.4B

Growth-seeking SMEs
open to equity

SOM

£500K–1M

8-10 portfolio companies
in first 3 years

Key Market Drivers

- 390,000 new UK businesses annually
- Bank lending to SMEs down 15%
- 73% of owners lack critical expertise
- Incubator market growing 7.9% CAGR
- £100M UK gov Innovation Accelerator
- Faith investing: £26B+ (Church Investors Group)

Revenue Model & Pricing

Equity for core consulting, everything else is fee-based

Equity (10-15%)

Embedded management consulting. Staged milestones.

**Core
service**

Training Fees

£150-£1,500/session.
Open to all businesses.

**Immediate
cash flow**

Financial Advisory

£300-£2,000 per engagement. Separate from equity.

**Immediate
cash flow**

Consulting Fees

£75-£150/hr for non-affiliated businesses.

**Immediate
cash flow**

Staged Equity Model

Stage 1 (3 months): 3-5% equity earned after diagnostic & pilot milestones

Stage 2 (months 4-12): 3-5% earned on growth KPIs

Stage 3 (month 12+): Remaining equity on independence milestones

Either party can exit at any stage boundary. Mustard Seed keeps only earned equity

Competitive Landscape

Positioned where no one else is

Traditional Accelerators

Programme	Investment	Equity	Duration	Embedded?
Techstars London	\$220K (SAFE + CEA)	5% min	13 weeks	No
Seedcamp	€75K (up to €200K)	7% (or 3%)	Ongoing	No
BGV	£60K	6-7%	6 weeks	No
Entrepreneur First	\$125K (SAFE)	8%	Multi-phase	No

Faith-Based Organisations

Organisation	Model	Investment?	Equity?	Embedded?
CREO Ventures	4-wk accelerator + venture lab	None	None	No
Navigators UK (NEC)	Peer entrepreneur community	None	None	No
Faith Driven VC	Christian VC fund	\$100K min (LPs)	VC terms	No

Mustard Seed's Unique Position

Only player combining. Equity investment + Embedded staff + Faith values + Separated pricing

- Traditional accelerators. Funding + mentorship, but no operational integration
- Faith organisations. Community + values, but no investment capital
- Mustard Seed: 10-15% equity for deep integration, with training & finance priced separately

Financial Projections

Bootstrap-first, designed to survive from Year 1

	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Year 4	Year 5
Revenue	£40K	£90K	£175K	£330K	£520K
Costs	£34K	£115K	£208K	£278K	£332K
Net Profit/(Loss)	£5.9K	(£24.5K)	(£32.9K)	£52.1K	£187.8K
Portfolio Equity Value	£30K	£120K	£350K	£700K	£1.4M
Portfolio Companies	3	7	10	14	18

Key Metrics

Year 1
Cash Positive

Yes

Startup
Cost

~£8.5K

Y5 Enterprise
Value

£1.6M

Founder-Led
Year 1

Solo

Y1 profitable as solo founder. Y2-3 dip during hiring/expansion. Full profitability returns Y4. Stress test. Even with 0 portfolio companies, consulting covers costs.

Scenario Analysis

Survivable across all scenarios

Scenario	Y1 Companies	Y5 Revenue	Y5 Equity Value	Break-Even	Survivable?
Optimistic	4	£680K	£2.2M	Year 1	Yes
Base Case	2-3	£520K	£1.4M	Year 1 (dip Y2-3)	Yes
Pessimistic	1	£280K	£400K	Year 2	Yes
Stress Test	0	£150K	£100K	Year 3	Yes — consulting covers costs

Why Every Scenario Survives

- Fee-based services generate revenue from month 1
- Solo founder = near-zero fixed costs
- No external funding required to launch
- Equity is upside, not survival dependency
- Staged equity limits exposure if companies fail
- Pilot structure allows course-correction
- Hiring triggered by revenue, not assumptions
- Worst case. Profitable lifestyle consulting business

Pilot Launch Strategy

Prove the model before scaling



Expansion triggers. Portfolio 4+ companies → hire consultant | Revenue £150K+ → consider seed round | No trigger → no spend

MUSTARD SEED

**"If you have faith as small as a mustard seed...
nothing will be impossible for you."**

Matthew 17:20

Thank You
Questions & Discussion